

# Setup Guide

Getting the full stack running on a new Mac — from a clean machine to a working demo

Prepared 2 Sep 2026 · Node/Laravel/PostgreSQL stack · for anyone running this project's code for the first time

This project has two parts you both need running at the same time: a **Laravel (PHP) API backend** and a **React (Vite) frontend**. The backend also runs a small real-time server (**Reverb**) for live updates. In total you'll have **three terminal tabs open** while demoing.

**Before you start:** you need the project's code folder (unzipped/copied from whoever sent it to you) somewhere on your Mac, e.g. your Desktop. Everything below assumes you're sitting in that folder in Terminal.

## 1 Install the tools (one-time)

| TOOL           | WHY                            | CHECK IT'S INSTALLED        |
|----------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Homebrew       | Installs everything else below | <code>brew -v</code>        |
| PHP 8.2+       | Runs the Laravel backend       | <code>php -v</code>         |
| Composer       | Installs PHP packages          | <code>composer -V</code>    |
| PostgreSQL 16  | The database                   | <code>psql --version</code> |
| Node.js 20 LTS | Runs the React frontend        | <code>node -v</code>        |

### 1.1 — Homebrew (skip if already installed)

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

Follow any on-screen instructions to add Homebrew to your PATH, then close and reopen Terminal.

## 1.2 — PHP and Composer

```
brew install php composer
```

## 1.3 — PostgreSQL

```
brew install postgresql@16  
brew services start postgresql@16  
createdb ayeyarwady_grill
```

If `createdb` says **"role does not exist"**, run `createuser -s $(whoami)` first, then try `createdb ayeyarwady_grill` again.

## 1.4 — Node.js

```
brew install node@20  
echo 'export PATH="/opt/homebrew/opt/node@20/bin:$PATH"' >> ~/.zshrc  
source ~/.zshrc
```

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## 2 Project setup (one-time, after you have the code)

## 2.1 — Backend (Laravel)

```
cd ayeyarwady-grill/backend
composer install
cp .env.example .env
php artisan key:generate
```

Open `backend/.env` in a text editor and check the database block matches your setup:

```
DB_CONNECTION=pgsql
DB_HOST=127.0.0.1
DB_PORT=5432
DB_DATABASE=ayeyarwady_grill
DB_USERNAME=your-mac-username-here
DB_PASSWORD=
```

**This is the step people usually get stuck on:** a fresh Homebrew Postgres install makes your **Mac username** the default database role, with no password. Run `whoami` in Terminal and put that value in `DB_USERNAME`, and leave `DB_PASSWORD` blank — *not* the placeholder `postgres` / `postgres` that ships in `.env.example`.

```
php artisan migrate
php artisan db:seed
php artisan storage:link
```

What each of these does:

- `migrate` — creates all 22 tables (21 domain tables + Sanctum's auth token table)
- `db:seed` — loads demo accounts, tables, menu items, and payment methods. Safe to re-run any time you want to reset back to a clean demo state.
- `storage:link` — creates the public link needed for uploaded images (payment screenshots, scan-to-pay QR codes) to actually be viewable in the browser. **Easy to forget — without it, uploaded images 404.**

## 2.2 — Frontend (React)

```
cd ../frontend
npm install
cp .env.example .env
```

The frontend's `.env` already points at `http://localhost:8000/api` (the Laravel backend) and matches the Reverb settings above — no editing needed here.

## 3 Running it (every time you demo)

Open **three Terminal tabs** (⌘T), one per command below, and leave them all running.

| TAB | DIRECTORY | COMMAND | CONFIRMS IT WORKED |
|-----|-----------|---------|--------------------|
|-----|-----------|---------|--------------------|

|                      |                        |                                           |                                              |
|----------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>1</b> API         | <code>backend/</code>  | <code>php artisan serve</code>            | "Server running on<br>http://127.0.0.1:8000" |
| <b>2</b><br>Realtime | <code>backend/</code>  | <code>php artisan<br/>reverb:start</code> | "Starting server on 0.0.0.0:8080"            |
| <b>3</b><br>Frontend | <code>frontend/</code> | <code>npm run dev</code>                  | "Local: http://localhost:5173/"              |

Open **http://localhost:5173** in your browser. That's the whole app.

## 4 Demo logins

| ROLE     | EMAIL                      | PASSWORD    |
|----------|----------------------------|-------------|
| Admin    | admin@ayeyarwadygrill.com  | password123 |
| Staff    | waiter@ayeyarwadygrill.com | password123 |
| Customer | customer@example.com       | password123 |

All three also show up right on the login page itself, under a "Demo login" box with a one-click "Fill in these credentials" button per role.

## 5 Troubleshooting

| SYMPTOM                                                                    | FIX                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Address already in use" on port 8000/5173/8080                            | Something's already running there — either a leftover Terminal tab from a previous attempt, or another app. Close it, or find/kill it: <code>lsof -i :8000</code> then <code>kill &lt;PID&gt;</code> .                                           |
| Uploaded images (payment screenshots, QR codes) show as broken             | You skipped <code>php artisan storage:link</code> in step 2.1 — run it, no restart needed.                                                                                                                                                       |
| Login fails with a database connection error                               | Check <code>DB_USERNAME</code> / <code>DB_PASSWORD</code> in <code>backend/.env</code> match your local Postgres (see 2.1's callout), and that <code>brew services list</code> shows <code>postgresql@16</code> as <code>started</code> .        |
| Staff/admin dashboard doesn't update live when a booking or order comes in | This build's Reverb (real-time) server has a known version-mismatch quirk that can silently drop the live push. It does <i>not</i> affect correctness — the booking/order was saved either way — just refresh the page to see the current state. |
| Want a completely clean demo state                                         | From <code>backend/</code> : <code>php artisan migrate:fresh --seed</code> wipes and recreates everything from scratch.                                                                                                                          |

## 6 Quick reference

```
# One-time setup
cd ayeyarwady-grill/backend && composer install && cp .env.example .env && php
artisan key:generate
# -- edit .env: DB_USERNAME to `whoami`, DB_PASSWORD blank --
php artisan migrate && php artisan db:seed && php artisan storage:link
cd ../frontend && npm install && cp .env.example .env

# Every time you demo - 3 tabs
cd backend && php artisan serve
cd backend && php artisan reverb:start
cd frontend && npm run dev
# then open http://localhost:5173
```